

This short text, known in Tibetan by its opening homage rather than a fixed title

Toh 793 · Derge Kangyur

This short text, known in Tibetan by its opening homage rather than a fixed title, and identifiable in Sanskrit as a dhāraṇī invoking the Buddha as sovereign of dates, lunar mansions, and instants of time, is a brief protective and ritual dhāraṇī text. It opens with homage to the Three Jewels and to this particular manifestation of the Buddha, followed by a mantra formula (tadyathā) addressed to the lunar mansions and astrological forces. The accompanying instructions explain a simple rite of recitation—reciting the dhāraṇī seven times before setting out in any direction—so as to ensure the accomplishment of one's aims. As Toh 793 in the Kangyur, it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī literature, short incantatory texts valued for their protective and auspicious ritual functions rather than for extended doctrinal exposition.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha who is the sovereign of the dates, the lunar mansions, and the instants.

Tadyathā: nakṣatre sarva-tīthī-mūrte naśatrani mesamita-dhani bhavantu svāhā.

As for its rite: whatever direction one wishes to go, if one recites this seven times and then sets out, all aims will be accomplished.

Thus concludes the dhāraṇī for the accomplishment of all aims.

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are transliterated Sanskrit as they appear in the Tibetan (in Tibetan phonetic rendering, e.g. "tadyathā... svāhā") and are preserved untranslated per convention for dhāraṇī material; their semantic content is not fully transparent and is traditionally left as sacred sound rather than rendered into English.
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Colophon

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texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.